

■ CONSTRUCT query

In most cases, we have a SPARQL endpoint where SPARQL queries are processed, and results are returned in the form of XML, RDF or even HTML. Most queries in many applications can be constructed automatically. An oft-quoted example of a SPARQL query is as follows, which lists all landlocked countries with a population greater than 15 million:

```
PREFIX rdfs: <http://www.w3.org/2000/01/rdf-schema#>
PREFIX type: <http://dbpedia.org/class/yago/>
PREFIX prop: <http://dbpedia.org/property/>
SELECT ?country_name ?population
WHERE {
    ?country a type:LandlockedCountries ;
        rdfs:label ?country_name ;
        prop:populationEstimate ?population .
    FILTER (?population > 15000000) .
}
```

Common vocabularies

There are a number of ontologies or vocabularies available online that allow you to describe common relationships among things, so that we do not need to describe them again and again. These are like a set of APIs that you can use. Some of the common vocabularies are FOAF (Friend of a Friend),

SIOC (Semantically Interlinked Online Communities), SKOS (Simple Knowledge Organisation System), etc. As an example, let us look at FOAF—it allows you to describe relationships between people and their surroundings.

These are just some of the technologies that you will encounter while thinking about the Semantic Web. While developing real-world applications, you might come across RDF Triplestores, which could allow you to store semantic data and query it like a database. There are also Web frameworks like Jena, for server-side technologies like Java, which allow you to develop Semantic Web applications. These usually provide an abstraction API for all the above-mentioned technologies like RDF, OWL and SPARQL.

I hope this article has made you aware of what the upcoming technologies are in the field of Web development. This article was aimed more at making you aware of what's going on, rather than providing a tutorial for building a Semantic Web application. **END** 

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The author has a crush on Java, and also loves flirting with almost anything else related to databases, cloud computing and Web technologies. Feel free to comment on this article, and direct your feedback to ankitreloaded@gmail.com.



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